

# SECOND SKIN

\_\_\_\_ B O U D O I R \_\_\_\_



## CLIENT POSING GUIDE

*What to expect, how posing works, and simple cues that help you  
feel prepared before your boudoir session.*

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PRIVATE. GUIDED. TASTEFUL.  
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START HERE

# This Is Not Homework

*You do not need to arrive knowing how to pose.*

This guide is meant to make the experience feel familiar before you walk in. It is not a list of poses you need to memorize.

During your session, you will be guided through every detail: where to look, how to place your hands, how to turn your shoulders, when to breathe, and how to move between poses.

## The simple promise

*You show up as you are. We guide the rest.*

## Inside this guide

- What happens during a session
- The posing foundations that flatter every body
- How to use hands, face, shoulders, hips, and breath
- Standing, seated, reclined, floor, wardrobe, and detail pose ideas
- How privacy, comfort, and consent are handled
- A day-of checklist and quick reference pose menu

# What to Expect

*A calm, private, fully guided experience.*

1

## Private consultation

We talk through your vision, comfort level, wardrobe, privacy preferences, and questions.

2

## Wardrobe selection

We review what you brought and choose pieces that photograph beautifully and feel like you.

3

## Guided posing

You are directed step by step. Nothing is expected of you without explanation.

4

## Small adjustments

Most posing is tiny refinements: chin, hands, shoulder, knees, toes, breath.

5

## Private image review

Your images are reviewed privately. Any image-use permissions are handled clearly and in writing.

# Comfort Comes First

*You are always allowed to pause, ask questions, or modify a pose.*

## Your control

- You choose what you wear.
- You decide your comfort level.
- You may pause at any time.
- You may say no to any pose.
- You may request a more covered or more modest version.
- You may bring a trusted female friend for support if desired.

## Professional direction

- Posing is explained before it is refined.
- Hands-on adjustments are avoided unless permission is requested and granted.
- You can ask for a demonstration instead of physical adjustment.
- Privacy preferences are discussed before any portfolio use.
- The experience is designed to be tasteful, calm, and respectful.

### A useful phrase

*If something feels uncomfortable, simply say: "Can we adjust this?" or "Can we try a softer version?"*

# The Posing Philosophy

*Boudoir posing is not about forcing your body into a shape. It is about small cues that create softness, confidence, and intention.*

## Lengthen

A long neck, relaxed shoulders, pointed toes, and soft posture create elegance without stiffness.

## Curve

Tiny changes in hips, knees, spine, and shoulder angle create shape and dimension.

## Soften

Relaxed hands, breath, jaw, and eyes keep the image from feeling overly posed or tense.

*Most of the time, the difference between "I feel awkward" and "that looks beautiful" is a two-inch adjustment.*

## Shoulders

Drop them down and away from the ears.

## Chin

Move slightly forward, then down a touch.

## Hands

Use soft contact, not pressure.

## Breath

Exhale slowly to relax your face and body.

## CORE CUES

# The Seven Foundations

*These are the cues you will hear most often during your session.*

### 1. Long neck

Imagine a string gently lifting the crown of your head.

### 2. Soft shoulders

Relax your shoulders down, then angle one slightly toward camera.

### 3. Gentle chin

Chin slightly forward and down can define the jawline.

### 4. Relaxed hands

Light fingertips look more graceful than a firm grip.

### 5. Hip shift

Putting weight into one hip creates natural shape.

### 6. Pointed toes

Pointed or extended feet lengthen the legs.

### 7. Breath

Slow breathing softens the mouth, eyes, and shoulders.

You will hear these repeatedly

*That is normal. Great posing is built from repeating simple cues until the movement feels natural.*

# Face and Expression

*Your face does not need to perform. Small changes create different moods.*

## Soft and romantic

- Eyes down or just off camera.
- Lips slightly parted after a slow exhale.
- Relax the forehead and jaw.
- Think calm, quiet, and present.

## Confident and direct

- Eyes to camera.
- Chin slightly forward and down.
- Small smile or soft serious expression.
- Breathe through the pose instead of holding still.

## Natural and playful

- Look away, then back to camera.
- Laugh between frames.
- Move your hair or robe slowly.
- Use movement instead of trying to freeze a perfect expression.

### Best trick

*Exhale slowly through your mouth. It relaxes the lips, jaw, shoulders, and eyes all at once.*

# Hands and Arms

*Hands can feel awkward because they have nowhere to go. We give them a purpose.*

## Good places for hands

- Collarbone or neck
- Hair or side of face
- Robe tie or shirt cuff
- Hip, waist, or upper thigh
- Bedsheet or blanket
- Jewelry, veil, or straps

## What to remember

- Use fingertips, not a full grip.
- Keep wrists soft and slightly curved.
- Separate fingers slightly.
- Avoid pressing into the body.
- Let one hand do something different than the other.
- When unsure, touch fabric lightly.

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SOFT FINGERTIPS

RELAXED WRIST

LIGHT CONTACT

SLOW MOVEMENT

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# Standing Poses

*Standing poses create elegant shape, length, and confidence.*

## Robe Wrap

Wrap a robe or sheet around the body, shift weight into one hip, drop shoulders, and look down or away.



## Wall Lean

Lean one shoulder or hip against a wall. Bend one knee and let hands rest on fabric or hair.



## Over the Shoulder

Turn away from camera, look back softly, and keep the shoulder nearest camera relaxed.



## Window Light

Angle your body toward light, chin down slightly, hands on robe or collarbone.



## Standing cue

*Do not lock both knees. A soft bend creates shape and makes the pose feel less stiff.*

# Seated Poses

*Seated poses are grounding, flattering, and usually feel easier once you settle in.*

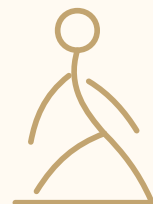
## Edge of Chair

Sit near the edge, lengthen the spine, angle knees slightly away, and relax the hands.



## Side Sit

Turn the knees to one side, lengthen through the waist, and look down toward your shoulder.



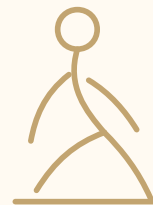
## Elbow to Knee

Lean forward slightly with a long neck. Keep the hand relaxed and fingers soft.



## Bedside Sit

Sit on the bed edge with one knee forward, shoulders angled, and toes pointed.



## Seated cue

*Sit tall first, then soften. Slouching can happen naturally, but starting tall gives the pose more intention.*

# Reclined Poses

*Reclined poses are about slow movement, breath, and small adjustments.*

## Side Recline

Lie on your side with knees softly bent.  
Use one arm as support and relax the  
top hand.



## Sheet Pull

Use a sheet or robe to create coverage,  
shape, and movement. Hands stay light.



## Tummy Pose

Lie on your stomach, bend one knee,  
point toes, and relax the shoulders.



## Arms Overhead

Lengthen the arms without locking  
them. Breathe to soften the ribcage and  
jaw.



## Reclined cue

*Move slowly. Tiny changes in chin, shoulder, and knee placement can completely change the image.*

# Floor Poses

*Floor poses can feel editorial, artistic, and beautifully relaxed.*

## When floor poses work well

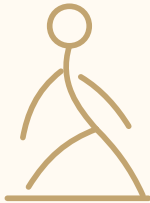
- With robes, sheets, or oversized shirts
- For soft, editorial images
- For implied or covered poses
- For detail shots of hands, lace, hair, or fabric
- When you want a more relaxed mood

## Common cues

- Bend one knee more than the other.
- Point or extend toes to lengthen the legs.
- Keep hands soft, often in hair or on fabric.
- Turn your face toward light.
- Take breaks if a position feels awkward or uncomfortable.

### Soft Floor Lean

One hand supports lightly, one knee bends, robe or sheet creates coverage.



### Draped Fabric

Fabric creates shape and privacy while allowing elegant movement.



# Wardrobe-Based Posing

*The outfit often determines the pose. You do not need to bring complicated pieces.*

## Bodysuit

Great for seated, standing, and over-the-shoulder poses. It gives structure and clean lines.

## Robe

Perfect for movement, coverage, soft shoulder poses, and privacy-first images.

## Oversized shirt

Relaxed, natural, and timeless. Beautiful for seated, bed, and casual editorial looks.

## Bridal pieces

Veils, garters, jewelry, and white pieces photograph beautifully for bridal boudoir.

## Heels

Helpful for leg shape, posture, and detail shots. You do not need to walk in them.

## Sheets and sweaters

Excellent for cozy, anonymous, detail-only, or more covered images.

## Wardrobe cue

*Bring options. We will help you choose what photographs best and what feels most comfortable.*

# Detail and Anonymous Images

*Beautiful images do not always need to show your full face or body.*

## Detail image ideas

- Hands on collarbone or robe tie
- Lace detail, straps, or fabric texture
- Rings, jewelry, heels, or veil
- Hair, shoulder, back, or silhouette
- Close-ups of hands, lips, or movement
- Cropped poses that preserve privacy

## Anonymous options may include

- Face turned away
- Images cropped below the eyes
- Back-facing poses
- Silhouettes
- Detail-only images
- Images reviewed and approved before any use

### Privacy reminder

*Your image-use preferences should always be discussed clearly and confirmed in writing.*

# Body Confidence

*You do not need to change your body before your session.*

Most clients arrive with at least one area they feel self-conscious about. That is normal. Good posing does not pretend those feelings do not exist - it works with care, lighting, angles, wardrobe, and direction.

## Arms

We create space between arm and torso, relax the shoulder, and use soft hand placement.

## Stomach

We use breath, fabric, seated angles, robe coverage, and posture to create a comfortable shape.

## Chest

Wardrobe, posture, and shoulder angle help create the mood you want, from soft to confident.

## Legs

Pointed toes, bent knees, and staggered legs create length and natural shape.

## Face

Chin, light, expression, and angle do most of the work. You do not need a perfect smile.

## Overall

The goal is not to hide you. The goal is to photograph you with care and intention.

# Breathing and Movement

*Still poses look best when they begin with movement.*

## Simple movement cues

- Look down, then back toward camera.
- Brush hair away from your face slowly.
- Pull the robe or sheet in gently.
- Shift weight from one hip to the other.
- Breathe out as the image is taken.
- Let a real laugh happen between frames.

## Why movement helps

- It keeps hands from feeling frozen.
- It makes expressions more natural.
- It creates fabric movement.
- It helps you stop overthinking.
- It gives the photographer beautiful in-between moments.

*Instead of trying to hold the perfect pose, think: move slowly,  
breathe, soften, repeat.*

# Common Mistakes

*These are easy to fix, and you will be reminded during the session.*

## Common habits

- Holding your breath
- Clenching fingers or toes
- Raising shoulders toward ears
- Locking both knees
- Pressing hands firmly into the body
- Trying to copy a pose exactly from Pinterest
- Apologizing for feeling awkward

## Easy corrections

- Exhale slowly.
- Soften the hands.
- Drop the shoulders.
- Bend one knee.
- Touch lightly with fingertips.
- Let the pose be adapted to your body.
- Let yourself be guided.

## Important

*Awkward moments are part of the process. They do not mean you are doing anything wrong.*

# Quick Pose Menu

*These are common pose families you may see during your session.*

## 1. Robe wrap

Soft coverage, shoulder angle, hands on robe.

## 2. Over shoulder

Turn away, look back, relax shoulder.

## 3. Wall lean

Weight into one hip, one knee soft.

## 4. Window light

Face toward light, eyes down or away.

## 5. Seated edge

Sit tall, knees angled, hands soft.

## 6. Side sit

Legs to side, long neck, shoulder forward.

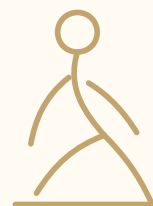
## Standing

Great for shape, confidence, and elegant lines.



## Seated

Grounded, approachable, and flattering.



# Quick Pose Menu

*More pose families used for variety, privacy, and softness.*

## 7. Side recline

Knees bent, one arm supporting, soft expression.

## 8. Tummy pose

Legs lifted or relaxed, shoulders down, chin soft.

## 9. Sheet pull

Fabric creates coverage and movement.

## 10. Hands in hair

Use slow movement, soft fingers, relaxed elbows.

## 11. Detail-only

Jewelry, lace, hands, collarbone, robe tie.

## 12. Silhouette

Shape, shadow, and privacy-friendly mood.

## Reclined

Slow, soft, and built from micro-adjustments.



## Details

Beautiful for anonymous or privacy-first images.



# Day-Of Checklist

*Small preparation choices help you feel more relaxed.*

## Bring

- 2-4 outfit options
- A robe, oversized shirt, or cozy layer
- Nude/black undergarments if useful
- Heels if you like them
- Jewelry, veil, or personal details
- Water and a small snack
- Any comfort item that helps you feel grounded

## Avoid stressing over

- Knowing how to pose
- Having the perfect body
- Buying all new wardrobe pieces
- Being nervous at first
- Having every detail figured out
- Looking like someone else
- Feeling confident every second

## Tip

*Avoid tight elastic marks right before the session if possible. Loose clothing beforehand can help.*

## OPTIONAL

# How to Practice at Home

*A little familiarity can help, but over-practicing can make you stiff.*

### Try this once or twice

1. Stand in front of a mirror and drop your shoulders.
2. Turn one hip slightly away from the mirror.
3. Touch your collarbone lightly with your fingertips.
4. Exhale and relax your mouth.
5. Look down, then slowly back up.
6. Notice what feels natural, not what looks perfect.

### Do not worry about

- Memorizing poses
- Practicing facial expressions for hours
- Finding your best side by yourself
- Trying to copy someone else exactly
- Feeling awkward at first

### Better goal

*Practice comfort, not performance.*

# Questions to Ask

*Your consultation is the right place to talk through anything that would help you feel safer, clearer, or more prepared.*

What level of coverage do I feel best in?

Do I want soft, romantic, bold, bridal, editorial, or cozy?

Are there any poses or angles I know I do not want?

Do I prefer face-visible, anonymous, or detail-only images?

Would I like to bring a trusted friend?

What outfits already make me feel confident?

What am I most nervous about?

What would make this experience feel successful for me?

The best sessions start with clarity

*You are allowed to be specific. Your preferences help shape the session.*

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# Final Reassurance

*You do not have to feel fearless before you begin.*

Most women arrive with a mix of excitement and nerves. That is not a problem - it is part of the experience.

Your job is not to perform. Your job is to communicate, breathe, and let yourself be guided one step at a time.

We will build the session around your comfort, your wardrobe, your privacy preferences, and the version of yourself you want to see.



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